

Seawall height in Riviera Beach

The elevation your city requires, the datum it is measured in, and the section of code that says so.

RIVIERA BEACH • PALM BEACH COUNTY

No minimum set in local code

Riviera Beach sets no seawall height. Dock permits must show the existing top-of-seawall elevation, but no minimum is required.

The detail

MINIMUM	None set
DOCK PLANS	Must show top of seawall elevation (information only) - Sec. 31-557
BULKHEAD LINES	Lake Worth bulkhead lines and fill limits - Ch. 22 Art. III, Sec. 22-61 to 22-67
FLOODPLAIN	Seawalls listed as other development, no elevation - Sec. 25-37
LAKE WORTH BULKHEAD LINES	Between the mainland and the Intracoastal the line is split at Blue Heron Boulevard (State Road 703) and follows U.S. harbor line points approved in 1926; a separate line covers the east side - Sec. 22-61, 22-62
FILL BAN	Since 27 Feb 1963 no fill beyond those lines; added lines near Phil Foster Park follow a county map of 21 March 1972 - Sec. 22-63, 22-64
EXTENDING LAND	City council permit with the city engineer's approval of plans, valid two years - Sec. 22-65, 22-66

Where this comes from: City of Riviera Beach Code, Ch. 22 Art. III Bulkhead Lines on Lake Worth; Ch. 31 Sec. 31-557 Residential docks

Verified: 2026-10. Rules change — check the date above against today.

Before you call a contractor

1

Know your datum

A height means nothing without the datum it is measured from. NAVD88 and MLW are different reference points and the same wall gives different numbers in each. Ask which one any quoted elevation refers to.

2 **Get the existing elevation surveyed**

You cannot tell whether a wall meets the requirement by looking at it. A surveyor shooting the top of the cap settles it in an hour.

3 **Ask what triggers the requirement**

Most cities only apply the minimum to new walls or to substantial repair. What counts as substantial is defined differently in each city, and it is usually a percentage of length or of cost.

4 **Ask about building higher now**

Several cities require a wall built below the final figure to be engineered so it can be raised later. Doing it once is cheaper than doing it twice.